



Renew your passport. Start studying Spanish and buy some sunscreen because it is time to start planning for the [2022] FC77 La Paz Gold Cup. For those who don't know, way back in 2019 I started a tournament in La Paz, Baja California. We took one FC77 team down, Old Nicks, and played the La Paz over 60's teams. This is a tournament the La Paz league put together just for us. It was a blast.

Reserve the dates - February 12-13, 2022. That's Valentine week. It works for more than the romantics among us. Airfare and accommodation rates will be close to the lowest of the year. And the weather in Portland is miserable.

The weather averages for February:

Portland - 50° / 38° 14 days of rain, Ocean temp 48°

La Paz - 80° / 55° 0 days of rain, Sea of Cortez 68°

Here's the process; Find out how many FC77 players want to go. I'm assuming every team will be a mix of FC77 members and guests. Hopefully we'll have enough people to field several teams. My thought is that each team needs to have close to maximum members. Last time we were a little thin. We played three games, but if we'd had a fourth game we would have been in trouble LOL.

Travel: Great news on the travel side. **American Airlines will be flying directly into La Paz.** I believe it is through Phoenix AZ. Mary Anne and I flew that route last year and it was great not to have that 2 1/2 hour drive up from Cabo. Almost everyone spent an extra 5 days to take advantage of what La Paz offers. Lodging was very affordable.

Covid Info: La Paz vaccine rate is 80% of the adults. So La Paz is doing great. It could be over 90% by the time we get there. It's just a matter of getting the vaccines in hand. Currently masks are still mandated. You may still have to have a Covid test to get back into the US. That is easy to arrange.

I can tell you that the league in La Paz is very excited to have us back. They are really looking forward to it.

So let me know if your team or just you are up for the Gold Cup! And what age bracket you'd want to play in and any other feedback or ideas you have.

I'll be sending out a more in depth information about travel, lodging and activities.

Cheers

Mike

9/15/21